

The Job Squeeze

NOVEMBER 24, 2008

The double whammy of a domestic slowdown and global financial crisis melts the job market. As low demand and money force firms to shelve investments and cut output, almost a million are on the wrong side of a pink slip.



“ The ‘bubble’ had to burst one day, but no one had expected a sound so deafening. Such that it would cause many hearts to stop beating. ”

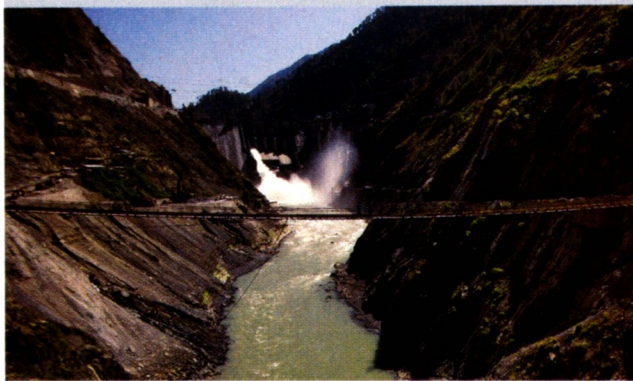
RAJNEESH BATRA, *Delhi*

Market Turmoil

The cover story brings to the fore the perils of improper planning. An economy where the service sector grew at an astounding rate and was dependent on foreign shores has now crumbled. Though nothing is lost, the Government should try its best to make amends by concentrating on infrastructure to boost the local economy.

ARCHANA NEGI,
via www.indiatoday.in

India's job market seems to be coming down much faster than it went up. This is because our companies went riding headlong on the wave of the economic boom and paying humongous salaries, never expecting the inevitable ebb. Employees in turn splurged and fell into debt like their employers. Now those who



Troubled Waters

Apart from global warming taking its toll on water, India's smaller neighbours, being plagued by political instability, may be intimidated by the country's geographical size and are not taking kindly to its growing global importance ("Rivers of Conflict", November 24). So they are refusing to cooperate in sharing water. NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, *Thiruvananthapuram*

Water has caused tension within and among nations. There have been over 500 conflicts in the past century. Mark Twain aptly said, "Whiskey is for drinking and water is for fighting." These issues are so contentious that there could be a war between India and its neighbours.

S.K. AGGARWAL, *Amritsar*

did not save and spend wisely will suffer. This catastrophic consequence also reflects the Government's inability to sustain its growth.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
Bangalore

The global economic slowdown was bound to have its impact on India, but the myth about our resilient economy has been badly exposed. Shedding dependence on the oxygen pipeline emanating from the US, we have to become self-reliant in all areas. Through optimum utilisation of available resources, we have to raise our production and income levels.

V.K. TANGRI,
via www.indiatoday.in

It came as a shock that an estimated million jobs have been lost through 2008.

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